Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.
If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.
If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥4

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♦
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣7

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 5♣
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥A

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣4

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9 8 4 2
♥ K Q 10 6
♦ 8 4
♣ A

♠ 6 5
♥ 8 3
♦ K Q 9 7
♣ J 10 5 3 2



♠ 10
♥ 9 7 4 2
♦ A J 5
♣ Q 9 8 7 6

♠ Q J 7 3
♥ A J 5
♦ 10 6 3 2
♣ K 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥4

NORTH has interest in slam after she hears SOUTH's Limit Raise. BUT, she should not use Blackwood holding two quick losers in the ♦ suit.

Instead she makes a Control showing bid of 4♣. (Not Gerber since it didn't follow a NT bid.)

SOUTH cooperates by making a Control bid of 4♥.

NORTH stops at 4♠ because neither partner controls ♦s.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q 10 4 2 ♥ 10 4 3 ♦ 5 ♣ 10 9 5 3 2	
♠ 6 ♥ K Q 8 7 2 ♦ A K 9 6 3 ♣ K Q		♠ A J 7 ♥ J 6 ♦ Q J 10 8 7 ♣ A 6 4
	♠ K 9 8 5 3 ♥ A 9 5 ♦ 4 2 ♣ J 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2♦	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
6♦			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♦ by East
Lead: ♣7

WEST decides it is unlikely that EAST is Aceless, so all he wants to know is the number of Aces EAST does have. He invokes RKC Blackwood.

Since no trump suit has been agreed, EAST bids as if ♦s, the last-bid suit prior to 4NT is agreed. EAST has two Key-cards plus the trump Queen, so she bids 5♠.

WEST bids 6♦. If EAST had just one Key-card, WEST would bid 5♦ over the 5♣ reply.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 6 ♥ K Q 8 7 2 ♦ K Q ♣ A K 9 6 3	
♠ A J 10 4 ♥ A 9 ♦ 9 8 7 5 3 2 ♣ 2	N W E S	♠ 9 8 5 3 2 ♥ 10 5 4 3 ♦ J 10 ♣ 5 4
	♠ K Q 7 ♥ J 6 ♦ A 6 4 ♣ Q J 10 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♣ by South
Lead: ♥A

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, NORTH has no problem as long as SOUTH holds at least one Key-card. When SOUTH responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), NORTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 4 ♥ 9 7 5 2 ♦ 9 5 4 3 ♣ 8 7 4 2	
♠ A 9 6 ♥ Q J 10 3 ♦ A Q J ♣ Q J 9		♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2 ♥ 4 ♦ K 6 ♣ A K 5
	♠ 10 3 ♥ A K 8 6 ♦ 10 8 7 2 ♣ 10 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♠	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			

6♠ by West
Lead: ♣4

EAST needs to know how many Aces WEST holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.